FORMAL SUBMISSION TO THE

DEPARTMENT OF COMMUNICATIONS AND DIGITAL TECHNOLOGIES

SUBJECT

Submission on the Draft South Africa National Artificial Intelligence Policy

Integration of Sovereign Execution Authority as a National Governance Substrate

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POSITIONING STATEMENT

This paper introduces Sovereign Execution Authority (SEA), a South African-developed execution governance architecture.

This submission is intended to support the Department's policy development and implementation pathways by introducing an execution-level governance mechanism aligned with existing regulatory structures.

1. INTRODUCTION AND STANDING

I welcome the opportunity to submit comments on South Africa's Draft National Artificial Intelligence Policy.

I do so in my capacity as Founder and CEO of Third Vision AI, a South African deep-technology company developing Sovereign Execution Authority, an execution-aware governance architecture designed to anchor authority, accountability, and real-time oversight in AI-enabled systems.

This work has not been developed in abstraction.

It has been shaped through engagement with real-world environments where artificial intelligence systems are increasingly embedded in operational processes. These include logistics corridors, industrial operations, civic infrastructure, and emerging financial systems.

In each of these domains, decisions do not remain theoretical.

They translate into actions.

Actions that carry immediate, material, and often irreversible consequences.

These environments are defined by variability.

Context shifts continuously.

Data changes.

Authority evolves.

In such conditions, governance cannot be static.

It cannot be episodic.

It cannot be retrospective.

It must operate at the moment where decisions become actions.

2. CORE POSITION

South Africa stands at a defining moment in the evolution of artificial intelligence.

The Draft Policy establishes a strong and necessary foundation.

However, the structure of governance remains incomplete.

As AI systems transition from decision-support tools to systems capable of initiating and executing real-world actions, execution-level governance becomes a structural requirement, not a design choice (Hughes et al., 2025; Shavit et al., 2023).

There is currently no enforceable mechanism that determines whether an AI system remains authorized at execution.

> ***If governance does not extend to execution, it does not govern the system. It observes it.***

3. AUTHORITY DRIFT

Authority Drift occurs when systems execute actions based on decisions that were valid when made but are no longer admissible.

Context changes.

Authority expires.

Data degrades (Parsa, 2026).

Yet execution proceeds.

This creates hidden systemic risk.

3A. Research Convergence

Research across domains confirms this shift toward runtime governance (Shavit et al., 2023; Hughes et al., 2025; Adabara et al., 2025).

However, existing approaches remain fragmented.

This submission defines:

- The condition — Authority Drift
- The location — Execution Boundary
- The mechanism — Sovereign Execution Authority

4. SOVEREIGN EXECUTION AUTHORITY

Sovereign Execution Authority validates:

Authority

Context

Admissibility

In real time.

Execution only proceeds if conditions remain valid.

> ***Sovereign Execution Authority should be understood as national governance infrastructure, not an application feature.***

5. EXECUTION BOUNDARY

Every action passes through a non-bypass-able boundary.

Outcomes:

- Approved
- Denied
- Halted

This transforms governance into real-time enforcement.

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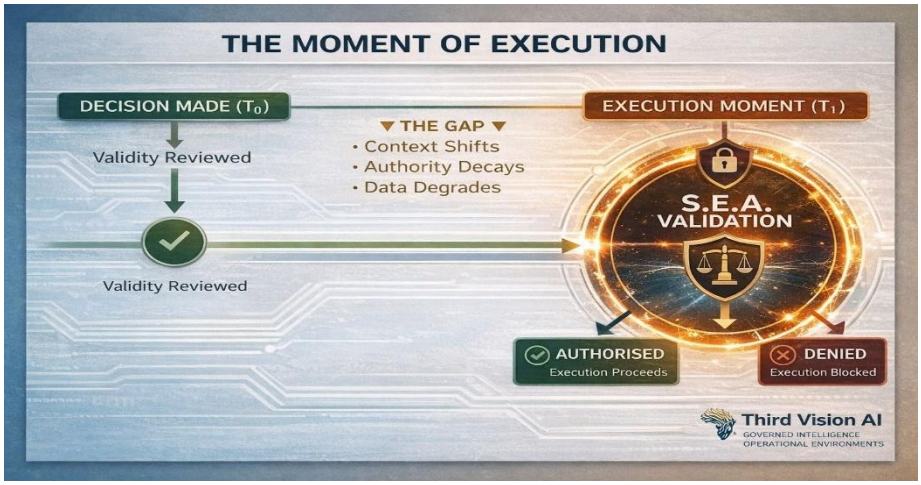


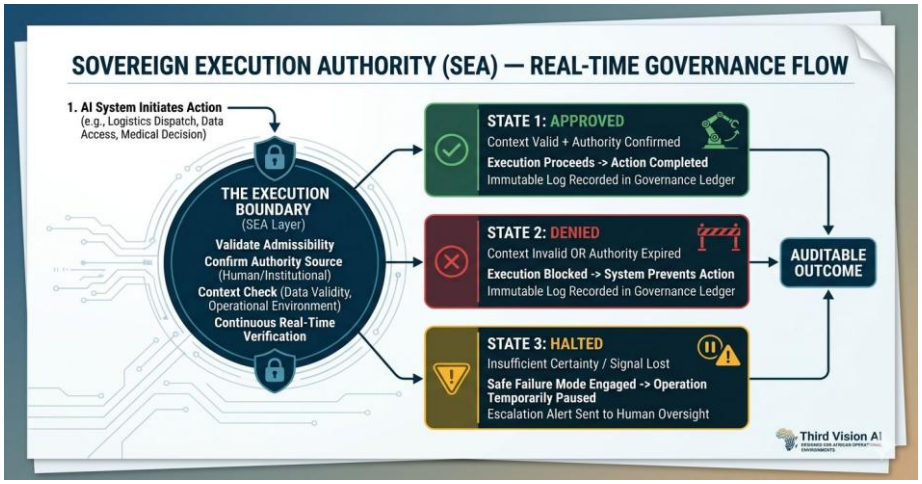
6. STRATEGIC RELEVANCE

Execution governance applies across:

- Logistics
- Mining
- Healthcare
- Finance
- Digital assets
- Smart cities
- Identity systems

For example:

> *A financial transaction authorized at time T_0 must be revalidated at execution time T_1 to ensure admissibility. Without execution-level validation, transactions may proceed under outdated authority.*



7. HUMAN DIGNITY AND INCLUSION

Execution governance ensures:

- Real-time identity validation
- Fair access
- Accountability

7B. Triple Intelligence Framework

Human Intelligence defines intent and accountability.

Artificial Intelligence provides scale and analysis.

Execution Intelligence determines admissibility in real time.

Together, they form:

The Third Mind

7C. Environmental Accountability (Carbon Heroes)

Sustainability must be enforced at execution.

Not reported afterward.

The Carbon Heroes Framework introduces:

- Real-time environmental validation
- Execution-level sustainability constraints

This aligns with broader governance research emphasizing embedded, real-time oversight in autonomous systems (Adabara et al., 2025).

8. SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE

Sovereign Execution Authority integrates governance directly into the execution layer of AI-enabled systems.

It operates as a non-bypass able control point through which all high-risk actions must pass prior to execution.

By resolving authority, context, and admissibility in real time, it ensures that governance is embedded within system behavior rather than applied externally.

This architecture enables continuous validation, structured accountability, and auditable execution across distributed systems.

9. IMPLEMENTATION

The integration of execution governance can be achieved through a phased approach.

Short Term: The policy should formally recognize execution-aware governance as a requirement for high-risk and execution-critical AI systems.

Medium Term: Pilot deployments should be established across sectors such as logistics, mining, healthcare, financial systems, ports, agriculture, and smart cities.

Long Term: Implementation can be supported through regulatory designation of execution-critical systems and the mandatory introduction of execution validation layers within those systems.

This creates a pathway from policy recognition to enforceable system design.

10. CONCLUSION

South Africa has the opportunity not only to regulate artificial intelligence.

But to define how governance is implemented at the point where decisions become actions.

By recognizing:

- Sovereign Execution Authority
- The Triple Intelligence Framework
- Execution-aware environmental accountability

The policy can move beyond principle.

Into enforceable, real-time governance.

Governance must meet execution in real time. Sustainability must be enforced at the moment of action.

11. REFERENCES AND SUPPORTING LITERATURE

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